a *mahayogi* – the prince of yogis. Fourthly, he is surrounded by animals, and Siva is par excellence the “Lord of Animals”, *Pashupati.*’[7] Reasons of delicacy may have led Marshall to make no mention of another feature: the figure’s erect member.

Since Marshall’s pronouncement several more proto-Shiva-as-Pashupati seals and tablets have been uncovered, four at Mohenjo-Daro and one at Harappa. What Marshall saw as the three-pronged trident of Lord Shiva is now seen to be a pair of horns with a branched plant or tree growing up between them, a feature found on a number of other seals. This did not prevent that much-respected husband-and-wife team of archaeologists and historians Raymond and Bridget Allchin from declaring in 1997 that here was clear evidence of Shiva worship at the centre of the Harappan Civilisation.[8]



Two examples of horned figures on seals. (Above, left) John Marshall’s damaged ‘proto-Siva’ seal as found in 1928. (Above, right) A sealing from 1938 showing a simpler version of a totemic horned figure, with the sapling between the horns more clearly defined.

But Shiva has never been a horned god. To my mind, the key element here is nature-worship. What many of the other